

# Inspection & Appraisal Guide

What they are, why they matter, and what buyers should expect.



## INSPECTION

- ✓ Condition of the home
- ✓ System & safety checks
- ✓ Repairs & maintenance
- ✓ What you can fix

VS.



## APPRAISAL

- ✓ Market value
- ✓ Comparable sales
- ✓ Lender requirement
- ✓ What it's worth



### INSIDE THIS GUIDE

Inspection vs. appraisal, what each one looks at, common outcomes, and how to stay calm and make smart decisions.



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Financing: Scott Smith • Citywide Home Mortgage • NMLS #2244351 (Co. NMLS #2611)



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# Two Steps. Two Purposes.

Both help protect your purchase — in different ways.

| Home Inspection                     | Home Appraisal                             |
|-------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------|
| Evaluates the condition of the home | Estimates the market value of the home     |
| Identifies potential issues         | Confirms value for the loan                |
| Helps you make an informed decision | Ordered by the lender                      |
| Goal: protect your investment       | Goal: protect the lender and confirm value |

# What a Home Inspection Looks At

A professional inspector evaluates the major components of the home.

## Roof & attic

Structure, covering, and signs of leaks.

## Plumbing

Pipes, fixtures, water pressure, and drainage.

## Electrical

Panel, wiring, outlets, and safety.

## HVAC

Heating, cooling system, and ventilation.

## Foundation & structure

Walls, floors, foundation, and structural integrity.

## Windows & doors

Operation, seals, and damage.

## Safety & interior

Smoke detectors, railings, stairs, and more.

## Appliances (if included)

Function and basic operation.

**TIP** Inspections are visual evaluations of accessible areas — not a guarantee or warranty.

**Know your home. Plan your next move.**

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# Common Inspection Outcomes

After the inspection, you have options.

- 1 Accept as-is**  
You're comfortable with the condition and move forward.

- 2 Ask for repairs**  
Request the seller fix specific issues before closing.

- 3 Ask for a credit**  
Request a credit at closing to cover the cost of repairs.

- 4 Negotiate**  
Negotiate a different price based on the findings.

- 5 Walk away**  
If the issues are too significant and your contract allows.



# What an Appraisal Looks At

The appraiser determines the market value of the home.

## Comparable sales

Recent sales of similar homes in the area.

## Property condition

Overall condition and functional utility.

## Location

Neighborhood, schools, and area trends.

## Size & features

Square footage, layout, updates, and amenities.

## Market conditions

Supply and demand in the current market.

## Loan requirements

Meets lender guidelines and standards.

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# What Can Happen After Appraisal

Once the appraisal is complete, there are several possible outcomes.

- 1 Value supports the price**  
You're able to move forward as planned.
- 2 Low appraisal**  
You may need to renegotiate or cover the difference.
- 3 Repair requirements**  
The lender may require repairs before closing.
- 4 Reconsideration of value**  
You can provide additional information for the appraiser to review.
- 5 Renegotiation**  
Negotiate price, credits, or terms with the seller.

# Stay Calm. Make Smart Decisions.

It's normal to feel overwhelmed — focus on what matters most.



## Don't panic over small items

No home is perfect. Focus on big-ticket items.



## Focus on safety & structure

Prioritize issues that affect safety or the home's integrity.



## Consider cost & long-term impact

Think about the true cost of repairs and future needs.



## Look at the big picture

Does the home fit your goals, lifestyle, and budget?



## Lean on your team

Mary, your inspector, and Scott are here for you.

Let's create your plan together.

Schedule your free strategy call at [movewithmaryv.com](https://movewithmaryv.com)

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